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THE IMPACT OF FINTECH AND DIGITAL FINANCIAL LITERACY ON FINANCIAL INCLUSION: EVIDENCE FROM VIETNAM

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Co-authored quantitative study · 340 respondents · Vietnam

Research question. How are fintech adoption and digital financial literacy associated with financial inclusion in Vietnam once demographic factors are taken into account?

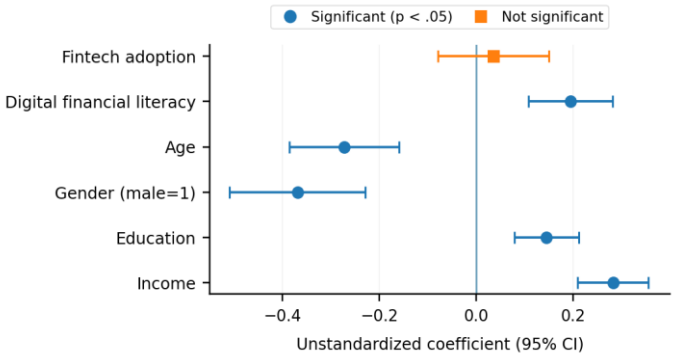
THEORETICAL FRAMEWORK

The study draws on the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM), Diffusion of Innovation Theory (DOI), and Financial Inclusion Theory to frame how technology adoption and financial capability may shape access to and use of formal financial services.

DATA & METHOD

- **Sample:** 340 complete online survey responses in Vietnam.
- **Measures:** Financial inclusion, fintech adoption, and digital financial literacy on five-point scales.
- **Model:** Multiple linear regression in Stata with robust standard errors; controls for age, gender, education, and income.
- **Model fit:** $R^2 = 0.3802$; $F(6,333) = 45.94$; $p < 0.001$.

FULL-SAMPLE REGRESSION



Unstandardized coefficients (b) with 95% confidence intervals; n = 340.

KEY FINDINGS

- **Digital financial literacy:** positive and statistically significant ($b = 0.194$, $p < 0.001$).
- **Income and education:** both show significant positive associations with financial inclusion.
- **Fintech adoption:** positive coefficient ($b = 0.035$) but not statistically significant in the full model ($p = 0.547$). Fintech adoption and digital financial literacy are strongly correlated ($r = 0.76$), suggesting substantial overlap in their relationships with financial inclusion.
- **Controls:** age and the male-coded gender variable are negative and statistically significant in the full model.

INTERPRETATION

The findings suggest that digital financial literacy is positively associated with financial inclusion after controlling for fintech adoption and demographic characteristics, whereas fintech adoption shows no statistically significant independent association once these factors are taken into account.

RESEARCH CONTRIBUTION

The study contributes Vietnam-focused empirical evidence by examining fintech adoption and digital financial literacy within the same regression model. It distinguishes the significant positive association of digital financial literacy with financial inclusion from the statistically insignificant association of fintech adoption after adjusting for digital financial literacy and demographic factors.

IMPLICATIONS

The findings support strengthening digital financial knowledge alongside continued investment in accessible digital-finance infrastructure. Practical priorities include financial education, cybersecurity awareness, user guidance, data security, and interoperable payment systems.

LIMITATION

Because the study uses non-probability online sampling, the findings reflect the surveyed sample rather than nationally representative estimates. Women account for 59% of respondents, and the cross-sectional, self-reported design does not establish causality.

WHY IT MATTERS

The study shifts attention from simply increasing adoption of digital financial tools toward whether users have the knowledge and skills to use those tools safely and effectively - a distinction with direct relevance to financial education and product design.

PUBLICATION

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